

test drive ■ MP3 Players

MuVo 64MB provides good value for those who want a no-frills MP3 player with good audio quality. However, the lack of an LCD screen and poor features will push music enthusiasts towards other, more recent, devices.

- + Good audio quality
 - + User-friendly
 - + Long battery life
 - No LCD
 - No voice recording or FM tuner
 - No playlist or folder support
- Price:** Rs 5,999

Creative Nomad MuVo 64MB		A
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Ease of use	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	

Philips Nike psa[64 Portable Sport Audio Your workout partner

Boasting of a splash-resistant egg-shaped design, the psa[64 MP3 player from Philips Nike is sports oriented. The buttons are covered with rubber, and an arm band lets you wear the device on your arm. The cord on the bundled earphones loops around the back of your head—the whole idea being to minimise obstruction in sporting activities. The device comes with a magnetic butterfly clip that can be used to secure the earphone cord to your clothes, as well as a wired remote with a magnet that can be stuck to the same clip.

The rubber-coated keypad has a three-way button for controlling next, previous, play and pause functions, apart from two small keys for controlling volume. The play and pause button also serves as a power switch. A button for hold, and another for selecting equalizer modes are located at the top, on either sides of the earphone socket. You can also control playback and volume using the rubber-covered remote.

You need to remove a lid at the rear to access the battery compartment and the USB connection. With its rugged feel and splash-proof design, this device does seem to be the best in the list as far as build quality is concerned. However, the magnetic butterfly clip obviously tends to stick to anything metal that comes close, even the earphone buds—that are covered by a metallic mesh. Secondly, the earphone cord feels short when you do not use the wired remote.

To connect the psa[64 to your PC, you have to install the bundled drivers before it is recognised as a removable drive.

Now you can use Windows Explorer or the bundled MusicMatch JukeBox application to transfer your music files. MusicMatch also allows you to convert CD music tracks to MP3 and WMA files. The Resample Rate feature in this application allows you to reformat the tracks transferred to a lower bit rate. This enables

you to fit more tracks onto the player by creating smaller files during the transfer, and does not affect the files stored on the computer. The 64 MB memory accommodates just enough tracks for your daily workouts or commutes—about 12 MP3s encoded at 160 Kbps.

There is no playlist support, and though you can create folders, the device will only play tracks stored in the root. Also, you cannot use it as portable storage as it doesn't allow you to store any other file types. You can choose from five equalizer



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